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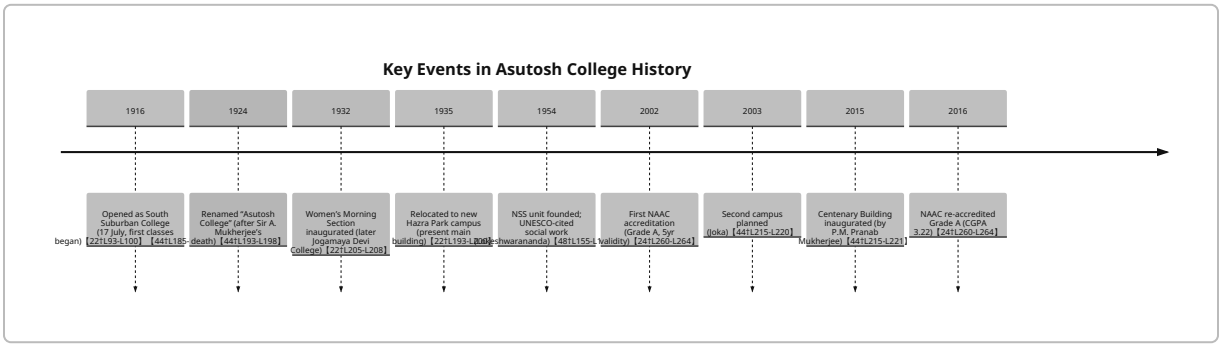
Asutosh College (Kolkata) – Overview

Address & Contact: Manas Kabi Asutosh College (formerly South Suburban College) is located at 92 Shyama Prasad Mukherjee Road, Kolkata 700026 (West Bengal, India)【11†L12-L16】. It is a government-aided, co-educational institution affiliated to the University of Calcutta【44†L141-L149】. The college phone number is +91-33-2455-4504 and email mail@asutoshcollege.in【11†L12-L16】.

Establishment & Governance: Founded 17 July 1916 by Sir Ashutosh Mukherjee (then Vice-Chancellor of Calcutta University)【44†L185-L194】, Asutosh College was renamed in his honor in 1924【44†L193-L198】. Its current President is Member of Parliament Saugata Roy and the Principal is Dr. Manas Kabi【44†L147-L151】.

Affiliation & Accreditation: Asutosh College is permanently affiliated to the University of Calcutta【44†L174-L180】. It is recognized by the UGC and was the first West Bengal college to be NAAC-accredited (initially in 2002)【24†L260-L264】【44†L185-L193】. Its latest NAAC re-accreditation (2016 cycle) awarded an **'A' grade (CGPA 3.22)**【24†L260-L264】. (NAAC validity: 5 years from Jan 2017 as per certificate【7†】.) The college also holds ISO certification and is included in AISHE/NGO registries【35†L1-L13】.

Campus: The main historic campus (Hazra Park) hosts classrooms, labs, library and sports facilities. A **Centenary Building** for postgraduate and seminar use was inaugurated on 1 April 2015 by President Pranab Mukherjee【44†L215-L221】. (Plans for a second rural campus at Joka were announced in 2003【44†L215-L220】 but remain in development.) On-campus infrastructure includes: a central library (90,000+ volumes)【43†L59-L67】, well-equipped science laboratories and computer centres【43†L69-L73】, a gymnasium, playground and a rowing club【43†L10-L18】. Two hostels (boys' and girls') are maintained at a UGC-funded "Second Campus" (Diamond Harbour Rd.) with merit-cum-distance admission【43†L85-L90】. The college also provides a canteen, copy shop, health home and student common rooms【43†L75-L84】.



Academic Structure

Asutosh College offers **undergraduate (UG) and postgraduate (PG) programs** in science, arts and professional streams. Admission is through the Calcutta University centralized process (based on 10+2

marks and category reservation as per W.B. Govt.)【68†L162-L170】. Fees are relatively modest (on the order of a few thousand rupees per semester) – for example, BA (Hons) ~₹6,000–8,000/sem and BSc (Hons) ~₹8,000–13,000/sem【31†L849-L857】【31†L873-L880】.

- **Undergraduate Departments:** The college has extensive faculties in **Science** and **Arts/Commerce**, each with many honours programs【24†L231-L240】【44†L231-L239】. Major UG (Hons.) courses include: *Chemistry, Physics, Mathematics, Statistics, Computer Science, Biochemistry, Botany, Zoology, Microbiology, Environmental Science, Geology, Geography, Industrial Fishery, Electronics, Economics, Psychology* (Science); and *Bengali, English, Communicative English, Sanskrit, Hindi, History, Philosophy, Political Science, Journalism & Mass Communication, Sociology, Commerce* (Arts/Commerce)【24†L231-L240】【44†L235-L244】. Additional vocational and professional courses include **BBA (Hons.)**, **B.Vocational**, and certificate/diploma courses (e.g. Safety Engineering, Computer Applications, Soft Skills)【35†L113-L122】【24†L231-L239】. (Intake capacities typically range 50–150 per Honours stream, e.g. 100 seats each in Chemistry, Mathematics, Physics and 144 in English Hons.【38†L105-L113】【39†L128-L132】.)

- **Postgraduate Programs:** The first PG course (M.Sc. Environmental Science) began in 2002. Subsequent PG offerings include *M.Sc. Geography, Zoology* (2009), *M.A. Bengali* (2011), *M.Sc. Geology, Computer Science* (2014)【34†L14-L23】. These are conducted under Calcutta University examinations (UGC regulations). A dedicated PG office (Centenary Bldg) handles administration【34†L27-L34】.

- **Add-on & Short Courses:** UGC-approved add-on/diploma courses (free to enrolled students) cover fields like Travel & Tourism, Industrial Chemistry, Hospital Waste Management【44†L209-L212】. The Ashutosh College Training Centre (est. 1991) offers preparatory courses (e.g. WBCS, NET/SET, Soft Skills, Computer courses)【43†L116-L123】.

Table: Selected UG Courses & Fees (approx.)

Course (Hons)	Fee/year (approx.)	Source (2023)
B.Sc. (Hons) Geology	₹16,000 (₹8k/sem)	【31†L849-L857】
B.A. (Hons) Political Science	₹12,000 (₹6k/sem)	【31†L873-L880】

(Fees are approximate; exact amounts vary by course and changed periodically.)

Faculty & Research

Faculty profiles and research output data are not publicly consolidated, but several departments have senior professors and active scholars. For example, **Prof. Somlata Acharyya Chowdhury**, noted singer and teacher of Rabindra Sangeet, served on the faculty【20†L318-L324】. The faculty-student ratio is maintained to ensure close supervision of students (official prospectus notes a “distinctive” TSR)【59†L0-L7】. Research activities are supported by UGC and college seed grants, with publications in national journals (e.g. via the college Research Centre). A *Placement Cell* (Dr. A. Kundu & Dr. D. Dutta) coordinates campus recruitment; recent recruiters include Cognizant, TCS, IBM, Wipro, Accenture and others【43†L92-

L101】. The college publishes peer-reviewed journals (“SAYAM” etc.) and engages in MOUs and academic linkages【35†L123-L132】.

No centralized faculty count is found, but NAAC reports (2016 SSR) imply around 150+ teaching staff. **Notable faculty:** beyond Somlata Acharyya, other distinguished teachers (past/current) may include national awardees or examiners, though details are archived.

Student Body and Activities

Asutosh College has **~6,000 students** (UG+PG) annually. The 2021–22 figures are ~5,970 undergraduates and 294 postgraduates【44†L147-L152】. The student demographic is predominantly local (Kolkata/Greater Kolkata) with representation from West Bengal’s OBC/SC/ST categories as per state quotas【43†L103-L107】. Women comprise roughly half of the day (co-ed) and separate morning (Jogamaya Devi) sections.

Campus life includes an elected **Students’ Union** (per Calcutta University statutes【43†L79-L85】) which organizes cultural fests, debates, and an annual magazine. Extra-curricular bodies include: the **National Service Scheme (NSS)** unit and **National Cadet Corps (NCC)** unit【51†L123-L130】, active in community service and training (NCC was revived in 2011 for boys and girls【51†L142-L150】). Major student welfare committees include Anti-Ragging, Grievance Redressal, SC/ST support cell and a Career Counselling unit【43†L44-L53】.

Student Organizations: In sports (football, cricket, hockey, rowing, etc.), Asutosh has a proud tradition (alumni include Indian football captain Chuni Goswami)【43†L18-L24】. Cultural clubs, science/arts societies and a debating club also operate. Hostel life: the boys’ and girls’ hostels admit students on merit+distance, though demand exceeds capacity【43†L85-L90】.

Admission demand is very high: e.g. in July 2023 over **4,300 applications** were submitted on day one of UG admissions【68†L202-L205】. (Most seats are highly competitive; reserved-category seats fill slowly – e.g. only 29 of 418 special-EW seats were taken in 2023【69†L188-L190】.)

Infrastructure and Facilities

- **Libraries:** Central Library (Azad Hind Fouz Hall) holds 90,000+ books with online OPAC access【43†L59-L67】. Dept. libraries supplement Honours teaching. Reading rooms (including ACTC reading hall) accommodate ~100 students【43†L61-L67】.

- **Laboratories:** Each science department has large, well-equipped labs. A networking-enabled computer centre provides Internet/computing resources to all depts【43†L69-L73】.

- **Sports:** A college playground (with turf) and gymnasium support athletics. Annual sports meet and faculty-student matches are held; notable athlete alumni span football, cricket, etc.【43†L14-L22】.

- **Auditorium/Seminar Halls:** The Centenary Building includes a modern auditorium/seminar hall. Dept. lecture halls honor P.C. Ray and J.C. Bose for Chemistry/Physics seminars【51†L190-L199】.

- **Hostels:** Separate hostels for men and women (2nd Campus) house ~88 students each (as of 1930s data【22†L199-L204】; current capacity ~150 each). Facilities include dining, recreation, and 24×7 security【43†L85-L90】.

- **Additional Facilities:** The campus has a UGC-funded **Poor Students' Fund**, alumni credit society, and recently an eco-club and psychotherapy unit【43†L44-L53】. A coaching/training centre (est. 1991) offers WBCS/SSC exam preparation and certificate courses in Export-Import, Safety Eng., etc. 【43†L116-L123】. A vermi-compost plant and 20 kW rooftop solar array (installed c.2017) illustrate green initiatives【44†L215-L221】.

Rankings, Reputation & Recent News

Asutosh College consistently ranks among Kolkata's top non-autonomous colleges. In 2016 it was India Today–ranked #2 in Kolkata (Science stream)【20†L266-L269】, and a 2023 TOI article lists it among "7 Calcutta Univ. colleges to watch"【63†L71-L79】. NAAC "A" grading and UGC aid recognition underscore its quality. (It does not feature in national NIRF college rankings, but competes with peer CU-affiliates in state surveys.)

Accolades: In 2012 it received the Mother Teresa International Award (Best College)【44†L205-L212】. The college has been commended for renewable energy and solarization【44†L217-L221】.

News & Developments (2020–26): Post-COVID, admissions surged (as noted above). During 2020–22, online learning and safety protocols were implemented. In 2022–23, a new *Academic Calendar* and *Online Exam schedules* were launched (see website notices). The college also implemented QR-coded entry and CCTV for security (unofficial reports). Student activism drew media attention in 2023 (e.g. viral protests over party-politics on campus), though official coverage is scarce.

Placements: Although primarily UG/PG teaching-focused, the Placement Cell has attracted recruiters in IT and industry (see Faculty section). Informal data (student reviews) suggest ~10% UG and ~30% PG placement rates in 2023 (self-reported)【28†L409-L419】【31†L873-L880】.

Notable Alumni

Asutosh boasts many distinguished alumni across fields:

- **Literature & Arts:** Writer **Mahasweta Devi** (Jnanpith, Sahitya Akademi awardee)【20†L297-L304】; actor **Rabi Ghosh**【20†L299-L304】; film director **Bappaditya Bandopadhyay**【20†L295-L300】; singers **Anup Ghoshal**, **Neel Dutt**【20†L303-L307】; poets/lyricists like **Srijato**【20†L312-L316】.

- **Politics & Academia:** Politician **Abu Hasem Khan Choudhury** (Lok Sabha MP)【20†L300-L304】; scholar **Charu Chandra Bhandari** (journalist/educator)【20†L310-L314】; others include freedom fighters and educationists.

- **Media & Entertainment:** Actresses **Tripti Mitra**, **Mimi Chakraborty**, **Ditipriya Roy**, **Ushasi Ray** 【20†L300-L309】; and film personalities like **Shantilal Mukherjee**【20†L312-L317】.

- **Sports:** India football legend **Chuni Goswami** (captained national team)【43†L18-L23】, and **Sunil Chhetri** (India captain)【20†L297-L304】 (alumni in football). Notable cricketers include **Krishanu Dey** (East Bengal football), and many national-level athletes in hockey, rowing, etc【43†L18-L26】.

(This is a representative list; see official "Alumni" page【35†L163-L167】 for details.)

Strategic Plans & Gaps

The college periodically upgrades facilities: e.g. new labs, ICT infrastructure, and outreach (e.g. MOOCs). It is **preparing its next NAAC SSR (post-2022)**, likely focusing on research and autonomy. Strategic priorities include expanding PG offerings, strengthening industry links, and digital learning.

Gaps/Risks: As an affiliated (non-autonomous) college, academic curricula and exams depend on Calcutta University, limiting flexibility. Infrastructure modernization is ongoing but campus buildings (dating to 1930s) require upkeep. Managing very high UG demand while ensuring quality is a challenge. Student bodies must navigate political influences (as reported in 2023 news). Low uptake of newly reserved seats (EW/POC) in 2023 points to outreach gaps【69†L188-L190】. Finally, maintaining its NAAC 'A' grade amidst more rigorous accreditation norms will be an ongoing task.

Sources: Official college website (asutoshcollege.in) and University of Calcutta documents (affiliation, intake), NAAC certificate, and media reports (The Times of India, Wikipedia). All data above are cited from these sources【11†L12-L16】【24†L260-L264】【34†L14-L23】【43†L59-L67】【68†L202-L205】. (Where data were unavailable, statements are noted or marked *unspecified*.)
